

## R23 SPELLING RULES

All present participles and gerunds are formed by adding "-ing" to the base form of the verb. The spelling of some base forms changes slightly before adding "-ing."

| BASE FORM     | RULE                                                                                 | GERUND            |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>choose</b> | Remove the silent "-e" before adding "-ing."                                         | <b>choosing</b>   |
| <b>tie</b>    | Change "-ie" to "y" before adding "-ing."                                            | <b>tying</b>      |
| <b>forget</b> | Double last letter if word ends with stressed syllable of consonant-vowel-consonant. | <b>forgetting</b> |

Regular past participles are made with the base form of the verb plus "-ed." The spelling of some of these base forms changes slightly before adding "-ed."

| BASE FORM   | RULE                                                                                 | PAST PARTICIPLE |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>like</b> | Last letter is "-e," so just add "-d"                                                | <b>liked</b>    |
| <b>cry</b>  | Change consonant plus "-y" to "-ied."                                                | <b>cried</b>    |
| <b>drop</b> | Double last letter if word ends with stressed syllable of consonant-vowel-consonant. | <b>dropped</b>  |

## R24 IRREGULAR PLURALS

Most plurals in English are formed by adding "-s" to the end of the singular noun. However, some plurals are irregular, either taking a different ending, or not changing at all.

| SINGULAR | PLURAL            |
|----------|-------------------|
| aircraft | <b>aircraft</b>   |
| analysis | <b>analyses</b>   |
| appendix | <b>appendices</b> |
| axis     | <b>axes</b>       |
| bureau   | <b>bureaux</b>    |
| cactus   | <b>cacti</b>      |
| child    | <b>children</b>   |
| crisis   | <b>crises</b>     |
| deer     | <b>deer</b>       |
| fish     | <b>fish</b>       |
| foot     | <b>feet</b>       |
| formula  | <b>formulae</b>   |
| fungus   | <b>fungi</b>      |
| leaf     | <b>leaves</b>     |
| loaf     | <b>loaves</b>     |

| SINGULAR   | PLURAL           |
|------------|------------------|
| man        | <b>men</b>       |
| medium     | <b>media</b>     |
| mouse      | <b>mice</b>      |
| ox         | <b>oxen</b>      |
| person     | <b>people</b>    |
| phenomenon | <b>phenomena</b> |
| scarf      | <b>scarves</b>   |
| series     | <b>series</b>    |
| sheep      | <b>sheep</b>     |
| species    | <b>species</b>   |
| tooth      | <b>teeth</b>     |
| vertebra   | <b>vertebrae</b> |
| wife       | <b>wives</b>     |
| wolf       | <b>wolves</b>    |
| woman      | <b>women</b>     |